



Pivoting Technique used to machine-stitch a corner. The machine is stopped at the corner with the needle in the fabric, then the foot is raised, the fabric turned following the direction of the corner, and the foot lowered for stitching to continue.

Pleat An even fold or series of folds in fabric, often partially stitched down.

Presser foot The part of a sewing machine that is lowered onto the fabric to hold it in place over the needle plate while stitching. There are different feet available.

Press studs Fasteners used as a lightweight hidden fastener.

PUL fabric (Polyurethane laminated fabric) A thin, waterproof fabric made by laminating cloth fabric so that it becomes waterproof on the wrong side. It is available through many online retailers.

PVC fabric (Polyvinyl chloride fabric) A synthetic, waterproof fabric with a sheen.

Raw edge Cut edge of fabric that requires finishing, for example using zigzag stitch, to prevent fraying.

Reverse stitch Machine stitch that simply stitches back over a row of stitches to secure the threads. Should be done at the beginning and end of a seam to secure it.

Right side The outer side of a fabric, or the visible part.

Rotary cutter Tool for cutting fabric neatly and easily, and useful for cutting multiple straight edges. It has different sizes of retractable blade.

Running stitch A simple, evenly spaced straight stitch separated by equal-sized spaces.

Seam Stitched line where two edges of fabric are joined together.

Seam allowance The amount of fabric allowed for on a pattern where sections are to be joined together by a seam. The distance between the raw edges of the fabric and the stitching line.

Stitch in the ditch A line of straight stitches sewn on the right side of the work, in the ditch created by a seam.

Straight stitch Plain machine stitch, used for most applications. The length of the stitch can be altered to suit the fabric.

Tacking stitch A temporary running stitch used to hold pieces of fabric together.

Tailor's chalk Square- or triangular-shaped piece of chalk used to mark fabric. Available in a variety of colours, tailor's chalk can be removed easily by brushing.

Topstitch Machine straight stitching worked on the right side of an item, close to the finished edge.

Topstitched seam A seam finished with a row of topstitching for decorative effect.

Towelling fabric Cotton fabric with loops on the surface. Also called terry cloth.

Velcro® Two-part fabric fastening consisting of two layers, a "hook" side and a "loop" side; when pressed together the two pieces stick to each other.

Wool roving A long, narrow bundle of wool fibres that have been carded, but not spun into yarn.

Wrong side Reverse side of a fabric; the inside of a garment or other item.

Zigzag stitch Machine stitch used to neaten and secure seam edges and for decorative purposes. The width and length of the zigzag can be altered.

Zip Fastening widely used on garments consisting of two strips of fabric tape, carrying specially shaped metal or plastic teeth that lock together by means of a pull or slider. Zips are available in different colours and weights.

Zip foot Narrow machine foot with a single toe that can be positioned on either side of the needle.

